centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

ISOTRETINOIN CARE

You (your child) have been prescribed an oral isotretinoin medication (such as Accutane) for severe acne. We will use the term 'Accutane' as an example, but the recommendations apply to all types of isotretinoin.

💊 HOW SHOULD I TAKE ACCUTANE?

- Take the medicine with a meal that has fat (like avocado, eggs, or cheese).

🩸 DO I NEED BLOOD TESTS OR OTHER TESTA?

- **YES**. You may need blood tests every month during treatment.
- If you CAN get pregnant:
    - **A pregnancy test every month is REQUIRED**
    - You must send a photo of the negative test by email to: dermatologie@centreup.ca

🚫 WHY IS IT DANGEROUS IF I GET PREGNANT?

- Accutane can cause serious birth defects in babies.
- If you are sexually active, you must use two forms of birth control AND do monthly pregnancy tests (*see above for email instructions*).
    - **If you become pregnant, STOP the medicine right away.**
- If these instructions are not followed, your dermatologist may stop the treatment.

🧴 WHAT CAN I DO TO HELP MY SKIN DURING TREATMENT?

- Use a hydrating lip balm several times a day.
- Apply a non-comedogenic moisturizer every day.
- Always wear sunscreen (SPF 30+).
- Avoid waxing, chemical peels, and laser treatments during and for 6 months after treatment.

⚠️ WHAT SIDE EFFECTS SHOULD I WATCH FOR?

🔥 **ACNE FULMINANS** is a very rare but serious type of acne. It can cause a sudden severe worsening of acne with very large*, painful pimples*, along with *fever*, fatigue, *muscle and joint pains*.

🤢 Other side effects may include:

- Severe headache and/or vision problems
- Abdominal pain
- Suicidal thoughts and depression

⊕ If this happens, you need to see a doctor right away. Check the Dermatology FAQ to book a follow-up at UP or go to a hospital emergency room.

*The recommendations provided in this document are based on general knowledge and experience in the field. However, the educational material contained in this document is NOT a substitute for the clinical judgment necessary to address the diverse needs of patients.